

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: From Firuz's death to Panipat

1388 Firuz dies -> succession and factional crisis

1398 Timur sacks Delhi -> 1414 Khizr Khan enters Delhi

1414-51 Sayyids -> 1451 Bahlul Lodi

1484 Jaunpur annexed -> 1489-1517 Sikandar Lodi

1526 Ibrahim defeated by Babur at First Panipat

RULE: Delhi contraction, regional vitality and dynastic transition overlap.

MUST REMEMBER: Timur's 1398 invasion was a major rupture but not the sole cause of Sultanate fragmentation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Structural fragmentation web

UNCERTAIN SUCCESSION + HEREDITARY OFFICE + NOBLE FACTION

|

provincial commanders retain revenue and military resources

|

distance, communication and army costs weaken rapid central response

|

regional agrarian-commercial bases sustain alternative courts

|

DELHI CONTRACTS before Timur; the invasion accelerates an existing crisis.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Decline versus regionalisation

DELHI-CENTRED VIEW

shrinking coercive reach
prestige loss and civil war
Timur's destructive raid

VALID CLAIM: Sultanate decline

BEST FORMULA: central contraction plus regional state formation.

SUBCONTINENTAL VIEW

Bengal, Gujarat, Malwa and Jaunpur states
active courts, trade and cultural patronage
regional political recomposition

INVALID CLAIM: all-India civilisational void

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Timur's raid as external shock

CENTRAL ASIA -> INDUS / PUNJAB -> DELHI, 1398

MOTIVES -> plunder + strategy + conquest ideology and self-justification

DELHI -> battle, sack, killing, captivity and severe disruption

WITHDRAWAL -> no durable all-India Timurid administration

POLITICAL EFFECT -> prestige collapse and openings for local powers

CAUTION: dramatic numbers in victory traditions are reported, not verified totals.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: How to read Timur's evidence

TIMURID MEMOIR / ZAFARNAMA -> route and justification | victory rhetoric
YAHYA SIRHINDI -> late Tughlaq/Sayyid sequence | Delhi-court perspective
AFIF -> pre-invasion Firuz context | patronage and celebratory framing
COINS / INSCRIPTIONS -> surviving authority | incomplete regional coverage
ARCHITECTURE / URBAN TRACE -> destruction and recovery | patchy survival
NUMBERS -> casualties, captives, armies and loot are reported, not audited
METHOD: source date + genre + claim + corroboration + residual uncertainty.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Sayyid ruler ladder and weak sovereignty

KHIZR KHAN 1414-21 -> Punjab base + Timurid link + limited Delhi sovereignty

MUBARAK SHAH 1421-34 -> campaigns, nobles and assassination

MUHAMMAD SHAH 1434-45 -> faction and restricted authority

ALAM SHAH 1445-51 -> Badaun withdrawal; Bahlul receives Delhi

STATE -> revenue + tribute + nobles + mobile coercion in a narrow core

CAUTION -> Sayyid descent and direct Timurid-subordination claims need evidence

VERDICT: limited state capacity was real history, not an empty interval.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Afghan political tradition

SOLIDARITY -> lineage and Roh recruitment could aggregate fighting power
CONSULTATION -> chiefs expected voice, honour and negotiated distribution
EQUALITY CLAIM -> armed nobles resisted extreme royal distance
MONARCHY PROBLEM -> central audit and discipline looked like status loss
CAUTION -> equality among chiefs was not social equality for subjects
RESULT -> mobilisation strength and recurrent centre-noble tension.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Bahlul's consolidation strategy

PUNJAB / SIRHIND BASE + AFGHAN RECRUITMENT

|

1451 Delhi takeover through bargaining and opportunity

|

personal alliance, territorial sharing and repeated campaigning

|

Sharqi contest -> Jaunpur annexed in 1484

VERDICT: Delhi recovered range, but partition logic remained embedded.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Sikandar's state-building toolkit

NOBLES -> court discipline, farman ritual and jagir account checks

REVENUE -> rent-rolls and gazz-i-Sikandari measurement

ECONOMY -> grain octroi abolition, roads and price stability reports

GEOGRAPHY -> Agra founded in 1506 for doab and western-eastern routes

CULTURE -> Persian learning beside sharper religious orthodoxy

VERDICT: strongest Lodi recovery, still bounded by Afghan bargaining.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Ibrahim's fracture and Panipat system

IBRAHIM CENTRALISES -> Afghan chiefs resist status and autonomy loss

DAULAT KHAN + ALAM KHAN + regional rivals -> coalition fracture

RANA SANGA / MEWAR -> active pressure; relationship with Babur remains debated

BABUR -> cavalry + artillery/firearms + carts/araba + tulughma

TACTICS -> field system + command + intelligence, not artillery alone

NUMBERS -> troop, elephant and casualty figures remain source claims

VERDICT: political contingency and battlefield integration decided Panipat.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Sayyids (1414-51) and Lodis (1451-1526) form distinct phases before Panipat I in 1526.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: 1526: decisive but not instantly final

CHANGE -> Lodi dynasty falls and Mughal imperial project enters Delhi-Agra

CONTINUITY -> revenue localities, service elites, forts and agrarian structures

RESISTANCE -> Afghan and Rajput powers remain politically consequential

MILITARY -> field artillery gains salience, but adaptation is organisational

HERITAGE -> Lodi tomb landscapes and repairs preserve late-Sultanate afterlives

RULE: dynastic replacement is not immediate subcontinental consolidation.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Afghan noble bargaining and regional states qualify any simple narrative of uninterrupted central decline.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 06 answer spine

OPEN -> define decline as Delhi's contraction, not India's collapse

CAUSES -> succession, elite autonomy, fiscal-military strain and regional bases

SHOCK -> Timur accelerates weakness; label evidence and numbers cautiously

TRANSITION -> Sayyid symbolism, Bahlul's recovery and Sikandar's administration

ENDGAME -> Ibrahim-noble fracture plus Babur's integrated battlefield system

CLOSE -> 1526 was decisive dynastically, incomplete politically and continuous institutionally.